

Browser Engines

There are very few major browser engines: Gecko by Mozilla, WebKit by Apple, Presto by Opera, and Trident by Internet Explorer

OpenDNS

If you ISP's DNS server is too slow, you can use free public DNS servers by OpenDNS and Google, or you can run your own server

EXPERIENCE RIA

A chat with Adobe on the latest in rich internet applications

d Developers in general and clients often ask the question which Rich Internet Application development tool should they choose – Flex, Silverlight, AJAX or any other framework. But with the excitement over HTML 5 this question in the RIA community has been circulating even more than usual. Where do you see Adobe and its products in the future across the RIA space against the HTML 5 backdrop?

Adobe envisions HTML5 technology along with Flash to complement each other in providing the best user experience for web applications and offering the developer the choice of platform. Flash platform, having been successfully used for several business critical applications offer well developed enterprise grade tooling to rely upon, such as profilers, and automated test tools. Over the years, Adobe has been investing in providing the best tools for HTML development. Ado-

be's products such as Dreamweaver are extremely popular and successful HTML development tools. With HTML5 offering RIA features, Adobe not only supports this in their products but also actively works with open source communities to strengthen the offerings for HTML5. For example, Adobe actively supports the jQuery community.

d What are the different factors a client should consider when having to choose the right RIA development tool?

Depending on the targeted market, different set of considerations apply. Any application that is targeted at general consumer needs to have the platform ubiquity as a key consideration. The chosen RIA platform needs to offer a rich set of library functions that enable the developer to offer compelling user experience. The RIA tooling should support development for

a diverse set of target devices – while the traditional browser based web applications running on PC clients are one of the major client platforms, the evolving requirement also includes offering the applications on tablets, cell phones etc that have different device capabilities. The tooling needs to support the complete lifecycle of development, testing, debugging, profiling etc for these devices to offer high productivity. For example, Adobe Flash and AIR runtimes are ubiquitous and also is supported well on a variety of devices. Adobe Flash Builder is a premier development environment that supports RIA development for multiscreen.

d While Silverlight is a relatively new framework compared to Flash/Flex, it's not entirely an unfamiliar territory for developers due to the fact that coding is done in .NET which is a more popular coding platform compared to something like ActionScript. Enterprises that work in .Net will find it easier to integrate interfaces and application designs created in Silverlight. Despite the obvious 'not everyone has



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